



ANNUAL REPORT 2008-09

COODU TRUST

H-83, R.M.Colony, Dindigul 624 001, Tamil Nadu, India, Tel : 0451 2461362 Fax : 0451 2421959
Email : coodustrustindia@gmail.com web : www.coodustrust.org

From the Director's Desk

It gives me immense pleasure to place before you the Annual Report of COODU Trust for the year 2008-2009, another remarkable year to report the our glorious achievements in initiating innovative programmes and activities. We have travelled a long road to carve a niche for itself, keeping steadfastly to its commitments towards women and children of the country. Its long 10 year saga has given the required impetus and stimulation in carrying out the mission, originally conceived to its focus and thrusts with renewed conviction and determination. The mission of COODU Trust is to facilitate rural development vigorously through governmental initiatives. The goal is to enrich the quality of life of the poor by meeting the basic needs and generating employment opportunities on a wider scale through decentralized planning. Our activities implies both the economic betterment of people as well as greater social transformation. In order to provide the rural people with better prospects for economic development, increased participation of people in the rural development programmes, decentralization of planning and greater access to credit were envisaged.

The main thrust for development was laid on agriculture sector, animal husbandry, women development, health and allied sectors with adequate support supplemented by direct and indirect involvement of people at the grass root level.

COODU Trust is working as an apex body in the area of public health and family welfare at Karur district of Tamil Nadu. It aims to achieve the well-being and vitality of the rural people. Our organisation has been addressing a wide range of issues on HIV/ AIDS, Mortuary van services to the rural poor, Public Health, Family counseling and Family Welfare Management by its multi-disciplinary functions in the form consultancy, education and training interventions.

Against the backdrop of the massive credit needs of rural development and the need to uplift the weaker sections in the rural areas, our voluntary agency with the assistance of Rastriya Mahila Kosh helped in the micro credit and micro finance to the Self Help Group women at Karur district. A new arrangement is being made in the village level for achieving the desired focus and thrust towards integration of credit activities in the context of the strategy for Integrated Rural Development.

It has been our continuous endeavour to improve our performance so that our organisation would serves its purpose more effectively.

With regards,
S. Jagadeesan,
Director.

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Genesis and Growth

COODU Trust emerged in year 2000 based on the motivation of a few young and dynamic like minded persons and professionals who pledged to do efficient, constructive and everlasting social development work for the under privileged of the society to develop self sufficient and self reliant communities. The name 'Coodu' signifies 'Nest' - a place of rest, comfort and security for those in search of the same. Coodu trust is a not for profit voluntary organization to under take charitable, educational and development activities for the welfare of downtrodden and marginalized needy people of society, including of fourteen districts of Tamil Nadu on watershed programmes and all the thirty districts for various social development work.

Over the years Coodu Trust emerged as one of the leading NGO in watershed development activities in Tamil Nadu especially on community organization and training programmes and research and documentation on various rural development issues. However we have decided in year 2006, to move on to two types of activities, Intensive grassroots activities in selected villages and districts and Technical and support services to development activities wherever needed. We have decided to work intensively among the communities on specific issues affecting them. We have selected Dindigul, Karur, Tirunelveli, Tiruchirappali and Kancheepuram districts for such intensive community development work including, Livelihood, women development, micro credit, health care, sanitation, environment, agriculture, HIV/AIDS and other activities addressing specific local problems for the following years.

The following years are going to be very challenging to create opportunities on specific issues to serve the communities with intensive grassroots activities on diversified development issues.

Vision

"Creating an egalitarian, self-reliant society by adopting latest and appropriate technologies sustained through participatory community efforts"

Mission

The Mission of Coodu Trust is to create an egalitarian society thereby reducing disparity between classes through a gender-based and human rights approach. It seeks to create a self-reliant society by harnessing use of Information Technology enhancing productivity, speed, accountability and thereby overall efficiency in project management. It also seeks to build relationships within communities by adopting participatory methods, ensuring that the benefits of development reach 'the disadvantaged and marginalized'.

Board of Trustees

Sl.No.	Name	Qualification	Office held
1	Mr. S. Jagadeesan	B.Sc., MBA,	Managing Trustee
2	Ms. B. Hemachitra	M.Sc., B.Ed.,	Committee Member
3	Mr. C.T.V. Chidambara Kumar	B.Com,	Committee Member
4	Mr. S. Raja	B.A.,	Committee Member
5	Ms. P. Mahalakshmi	M.Sc., M.Phil,	Committee Member
6	Mr. D. Srinivasan	M.Sc., M.Phil, B.Ed.,	Committee Member
7	Mr. K. Samidurai	M.Sc.,	Committee Member
8	Ms. S. Rani	M.A.,	Committee Member

Thrust Area

- ➔ Improve the overall socio, economic conditions of the poor, needy and disadvantaged communities.
- ➔ Undertake need based, people oriented, research and action based programmes in various developmental issues.
- ➔ Conceptualize, identify, design, train and implement various developmental projects to improve the livelihoods of different communities.
- ➔ Engage in the promotion of sustainable agriculture and rural development.
- ➔ Foster development education in different sectors and create awareness on various social problems.
- ➔ Provide consultancy services in project design, management and evaluation of developmental projects

Agricultural and horticultural development

Vermicomposting

Vermiculture means artificial rearing or cultivation of Earthworms and the technology is the scientific process of using them for the betterment of human beings. Vermicompost is the excreta of earthworm, which is rich in humus. Earthworms eat cow dung or farm yard manure along with other farm wastes and pass it through their body and in the process convert it into vermicompost. The municipal wastes; non-toxic solid and liquid waste of the industries and household garbage's can also be converted into vermicompost in the same manner.



Highlights:

Skill development training was imparted to 32 number of participants, funded by NABARD, Karur for 7 days and 250 number of participants with the financial assistance of DRDA, Dindigul for one day with 50 beneficiaries in each batch for 5 batches. To provoke the technical skill of the beneficiaries and for the entrepreneurial development of the rural women in Mylampatti village of Kadavur block of Karur district, 50 number of vermicomposting units were erected with a thatched roof shed, open from all sides with unpaved (katcha) floor in East-West direction length wise to protect the site from direct sunlight. The base of the site was raised 6 inches above ground to protect it from flooding during the rains.

Enriched farmyard production

The cost of slurry disposal on the farm by spraying over

grass is unlikely to be recovered by the resulting improvements in grass yield. By enriching slurry with another fertilizer, for example poultry manure or inorganic N-P-K, slurry disposal and fertilizer application could be performed in one operation. Under high temperature conditions, the use of poultry manure and slurry gave better results when they were applied alone rather than together, but a mixture of slurry and inorganic N-P-K produced an overall advantage over inorganic N-P-K alone.



Highlights:

20 number of demonstration were laid out in Velliyanai village of Thanthoni block of Karur district in the farmers field. To enumerate the advantage of enriched farm yard manure 12 number of trainings were imparted to 245 number of beneficiaries of the same village.

Use of bio agents in agriculture

Biological control agent is any agent who is non-chemical and natural and acts to control the incidence of disease or pest. Biological control agents could be that of antagonist agents. The domestic market for biological control agents is estimated to be around one to two per cent of the total pesticides market. This market is fast growing and should reach about 15 to 20 per cent of the total pesticides market within the next decade. There is a growing awareness to the use of biological control agents globally.

Highlights:

Awareness about the usage of bio agents in agriculture is a lacuna among the rural farmers. To high lighten the importance of bio agents in agriculture and to create awareness among the farming community on the hazardous affect of chemicals in

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agriculture, 5 number of trainings were imparted to 103 number of beneficiaries.

Conservative farming system

Conventional, intensive tillage farming systems have greatly increased crop production and labour efficiency. But, serious questions are being raised about the energy-intensive nature of these systems and their adverse effects on soil productivity and environmental quality. This concern has led to an increasing interest in organic farming systems because they may reduce some of the negative effects of conventional agriculture on the environment. The organically-farmed soil had significantly higher organic matter content, thicker topsoil depth, higher polysaccharide content, lower modulus of rupture and less soil erosion than the conventionally-farmed soil.



Highlights:

A debate was organized comparing the conventional and organic farming system between the farmers group encompassing two group of progressive farmers of Kadavur block of Karur district with 25 number of farmers in each group, at the training centre at Mylampatti village. This gave a positive solutions of the organic farming system.

Use of traditional practices

Crop production began perhaps 10,000 years ago. Some ancient farmers developed sustainable agriculture practices that allowed them to produce food and fiber and manage plant diseases for thousands of years with few outside inputs. Many of their successful practices have

been forgotten or abandoned in developed countries, but some are still used by traditional farmers in a wide variety of



environments in developing countries. Traditional farming usually is based on practices that have been passed down for many generations.

Highlights:

We envisaged towards the objective of training the farmers with an overview of the range of methods used to restrict plant diseases without reliance on external or synthetic inputs. Perhaps 3 number of trainings were imparted to 72 number of beneficiaries with the eminent resource persons from Gandhigram Rural University, in the aspect of indigenous traditional knowledge in the farming system.

Horticultural crop production and management

The emergence of horticulture as a growth engine of agriculture sector in recent years have a great of an impetus to



Agricultural and horticultural development

cultivation, processing and marketing of vegetables, fruits and flowers in the state. Though Tamil Nadu ranks first in banana production and second in productivity, ranks first in productivity and second in production of tapioca, ranks first in productivity of cabbage and ranks first in productivity of flowers and the marketing intelligence system is an lacuna among the farming community. They are not aware of various subsidies are being provided to the farmers.

Highlights:

Training was imparted to 75 horticultural crop growers of Dindigul with the technically competent scientist from Krishi Vigyan Kendra of Gandhigram Rural University for 2 days on market led extension of horticultural produces. They were also give awareness on the various schemes available for the farmers from governmental organizations.

Exposure visit was performed with 120 farmers of Vadamadurai block to Nilgiris market, Oddanchataram market and Tamil Nadu Agricultural University for 3 days under IWDP, as we believe that *Seeing is believing*.

Integrated Farming System

Farming system approach envisages the integration of agroforestry, horticulture, dairy, sheep and goat rearing, fishery, poultry, pigeon, biogas, mushroom, sericulture and by-product utilization of crops with the main goal of increasing the income and standard of living of small and marginal farmers. The challenge is to upgrade the technological and social disciplines on a continuous basis



and integrate these disciplines to suit the region and the farm families in a manner that may ensure increased production with stability, ecological sustainability and equitability.

Highlights:

An Integrated Farming demonstration model had been established at Valliyani village of Thanthoni block at Karur district with integration of agro forestry, horticulture, dairy, mushroom, Vermicompost unit, biogas, backyard poultry and goat unit. This model imparts education and training to the farmers and self help woman groups.

Environmental awareness



National Environment Awareness Campaign launched by the Ministry of Environment & Forests, Government of India in 1986 projected a themes under the umbrella of "Climate Change".

Highlights:

An awareness training on Climate Change was conducted for elected representative at Kadavur block in collaboration with Nehru Yuva Kendra, Karur.

Medicinal plants

Plants have been used in traditional medicine for several thousand years. The knowledge of medicinal plants has been accumulated in the course of many centuries based on different medicinal systems such as Ayurveda, Unani and

Agricultural and horticultural development

Siddha. In India, it is reported that traditional healers use 2500 plant species and 100 species of plants serve as regular sources of medicine.



Highlights:

An ethno-botanical garden has been established at Mayilampatty field office at Karur district in order to conserve the medicinal plant species known to various ethnic communities of the region. The size of the garden is 3 acres and the garden is being managed by our NGO. This garden impart education and training to different users such as farmers, schools, colleges, folk healers and self help woman groups.

Bamboo cultivation

Field performance of micro and macro-propagated planting stock of selected five commercially important Bamboo species had been demonstrated at Vellayanai



village of Thanthoni block in Karur district in

collaboration with **Institute of Forest Genetics and Tree Breeding, Coimbatore.**

Highlights:

It is a networking project among IFGTB, IWST and KFRI for raising demonstration trial of tissue culture (TC) plants for five species. IFGTB had established trials for three species namely *Dendrocalamus strictus*, *Pseudoxytenanthera stockii* and *Bambusa bambos* in an area of 15 acres with 28 different varieties. Growth performance of the tissue culture raised plants is being assessed with the seedling raised plants.

Mushroom production

Mushroom production is completely different from growing green plants. Commercial cultivation of mushrooms is not for everyone. It requires someone who is familiar with fungi life cycles and willing to commit time and money to research, designing a system, and developing a business. The mushroom cultivator must be able to carry out operations on time, be attentive to details, and be vigilant about pest invasions. In most cases, marketing requires excellent public relations skills. Nevertheless, there is potential for an innovator who can use an existing facility, obtain a low-cost substrate, and produce a reliable supply of a high quality product. As part of a whole-farm system, mushrooms can augment productivity at any scale.



Agricultural and horticultural development

Highlights:

Producing a nutritious food at a profit, while using materials that would otherwise be considered "waste," constitutes a valuable service in the self-sustaining community we might envision for the future. It is a challenge some will find worth taking. To facilitate this training were imparted to 25 needy farmers of Karur district under skill oriented programme funded by NABARD for fifteen days.

Post harvest management of agricultural crops

Use of appropriate post harvest technology reduces the post harvest and storage losses; adds value to the product, generate employment in village and reestablishes agro-industries in rural sector. Presently, the farmers sell their products without processing. If they do primary processing and value addition in the villages, it will generate more income and employment in rural sector. The processing of food, feed, fiber, oilseeds and sugarcane will generate enough employment in rural areas.

Highlights:

Training was imparted to 75 farmers of Naganeri block of Thirunelveli district with the agricultural scientist on Post harvest management of agricultural crops for 2 days. If an agro processing center is established in each big village or a cluster of small villages of the targeted area on primary processing, it will generate employment to about 4-5 persons and will increase income of the farmer/processor by about 15-20 percent. Use of proper post harvest technology of perishables and semi-perishables will reduce the wastage to great extent.

Value addition of agricultural and horticultural produces

Post-harvest value addition includes primary, secondary, and tertiary processing, operations performed on

farm produce. It is to provide longer shelf life, maintain/improve quality, and enhance form, space and time utility of the produce for food, feed, fiber, fuel and industrial purposes. The post harvest operations include on-farm handling, cleaning, grading, moisture conditioning, milling, extraction, cooling, freezing, roasting, puffing, flaking, re-tort processing, packaging, transport, and storage. Awareness was created among the farmers to build capacity on the value addition of agricultural and horticultural produces.

Highlights:

Training was imparted to 57 farmers of Kadavur block of Karur district with the agricultural and home scientist on value addition of agricultural and horticultural produces for 2 days.

Calf rearing

Banks have been focusing mainly on financing of milch animals under various government sponsored programmes and dairy activities. Calf rearing scheme has not been popular among farmers also for a number of reasons like its long gestation period, disbursement being made over a period of 2 ½ years in small amounts and unwillingness of the farmer to take up such a long term activity. Normally, when a cow is purchased under a bank loan, a calf at foot (of one month age) is also purchased along with the cow. Half of such calves are females and can be grown as quality cows if they are cross bred. Since borrowers are financed for a minimum of 2 cows with a gap of 6 months in between, most of the farmers will have at least one female cross bred calf which can be covered with the proposed scheme.

Highlights:

Genuine women farmers interested in dairy activity were covered under the scheme of Rastriya Mahila Kosh. Even though dairying is a traditional activity in our country, it is important that the banks ensure that the farmers are trained well in calf rearing before finance is made available. So training was imparted to 40 number of women beneficiaries and loan was availed by 38 beneficiaries under

Animal Husbandry

Rastriya Mahila Kosh. Even a small dairy farmer were encouraged to go in for calf rearing as the space requirement and other help needed was very minimal for this activity.

Backyard poultry

Rural backyard poultry, though still contributing nearly 30% to the national egg production, is the most neglected one. This is in spite of the fact that their poultry eggs and meat fetch a much higher price than that from commercial poultry. It is well known fact that a fairly significant proportion of the landless and marginal farmers eke out their living from poultry and other small ruminants. Backyard poultry requiring hardly any infrastructure set-up is a potent tool for upliftment of the poorest of the poor. Besides income generation, Rural backyard poultry provides nutrition supplementation in the form of valuable animal protein and empowers women.

Highlights:

4 number of units were being established in Kadavur area to uplift the women farming community in Mettupatty village. In the initial phase 25 number of women farmers were trained on backyard poultry to enhance the skill orientation and up gradation of the rural community.

Goat rearing

Goats are among the main meat-producing animals in India, whose meat (chevron) is one of the choicest meats and has huge domestic demand. Due to its good economic prospects, goat rearing under intensive and semi-intensive system for commercial production has been gaining momentum for the past couple of years.

Highlights:

Goat farming system was established with the technical backup of UVTRC Karur and 10 number of commercial goat farms were established in different areas of

Kadavur block of Karur district with the financial assistance of Mahalir Thittam.

Sheep rearing

Sheep with its multi-facet utility for wool, meat, milk, skins and manure, form an important component of rural economy particularly in the arid, semi-arid areas of the Tamil Nadu. It provides a dependable source of income to the shepherds through sale of wool and animals. The advantages of sheep farming viz., Sheep do not need expensive buildings to house them and on the other hand require less labour than other kinds of livestock. Sheep are economical converter of grass into meat and wool. Sheep will eat varied kinds of plants compared to other kind of livestock. This makes them excellent weed destroyer.

Highlights:

High demand for sheep and its products with potential of good economic returns have been deriving many progressive farmers and educated youths to take up the goat enterprise on a commercial scale. The emerging favourable market conditions and easy accessibility to improved sheep rearing technologies are also catching the attention of entrepreneurs. 120 number of commercial sheep farms were established in different areas of Kadavur block of Karur district with the financial assistance of Mahalir Thittam.

Women development

COODU Trust is working towards the capacity building of poor and disadvantaged women to enable them to cross all social and economic barriers, and thereby facilitate their full development into empowered citizens. Our vision and mission lies with the achievement of the equality of status of poor women as participants, decision makers and beneficiaries in the democratic, economic, social and cultural spheres of life.

Social and economical of women development

The programmes of women development were performed

Women Development

towards creating or reorienting democratic, economic and social processes to enable poor women to participate fully and actively in decision-making in the family and community level. As we are the approved NGO for **Mahalir Thittam** in Karur district of Tamil Nadu, the programmes were oriented to emphasis the empowerment of women to work together with men as equal partners and to inspire a new generation of women and men to work together for equality, sustainable development, and communal harmony.

Highlights:

Our programmes usually forecast in the promotion of human rights of women at all stages of their life cycle. As a capacity building phase, we gave 10 programmes on entrepreneurial development for the SHG women, on small scale industries formulation and group dynamics/leadership. As our thought is developing group for social mobilization, we formulated 360 number of SHG at Karur district.

Now we have facilitated for the provision of Rs. 44,50,000 amount of revolving fund for 85 number of SHG's with due linkage with Nationalized banks. Economic assistance of Rs.17,00,000 was catalyzed for 4 groups of Kadavur block of Karur district, with the concept of Mahalir Thittam. With enhanced linkages with other banks we have linked 35 Self Help Groups and soft loan of Rs.38,95,000 was availed for economic empowerment.

Micro finance and micro insurance

As far as the micro-finance and micro insurance programs are considered, this is a foremost focusing on providing savings and credit services only. A range of other financial services including insurance and other support services were provided along with savings and credit services. **COODU Trust is being supported by Rastriya Mahila Kosh under Ministry of Women and Child Development, with a main objective of providing**

and promoting micro-credit among poor women for income generation activities or for asset creation.

Highlights:

We are performing this programme among 40 Women Self Help Group by demonstrating and replicating participatory approaches women's groups for thrift and savings with effective utilization of credit. In this programme 30 women farmers trained, were provided with one milch animal each to support their livelihood. In order to have a assured income throughout the year 10 women were provided with credit for petty shop and sheep rearing activities. Totally a financial outlay of Rs.7.5 lakhs was supported by RMK in the first phase for socio economic development of the women. The main sole aim is women's empowerment, socio-economic change and development in the female population.

Skill orientation with market linkage

Research-extension-farmer linkages for market orientation was viewed from a context of empowering farmers to farm as a business. Therefore, we intruded in the establishment of linkages that will empower women farmers' production capacity and market participation through favourable policy, technology and advice. The advices included not only production technology, enterprise & business development services, market information and financial services also. The project was carried out in Karur district.

Highlights:

Skill oriented training on **Mushroom production technology** was imparted to 50 Self Help Group farm women. The aim was to empower mushroom production in a small scale among the women farmers.

A training on **Vermicomposting** was conducted and convened for 72 Self Help Group farm women members. This training would facilitate in vermicompost, vermin wash and earthworm production, that may facilitated in sustainable

Women Development

organic production in agricultural with ensured marketing. As a first step in linkages development, the roles and responsibilities of each partner were clearly spelt and were based on areas they and comparative advantage. In order to support the women folk in rural areas, 43 women members of 3 Women Self Help Group were trained in latest handloom weaving and market link was facilitated. Fifty rural youth (women) were trained in the aspect of tailoring of made-ups, which is having high market enquiry in the garment stores.

Women development in watershed areas

Women and men have distinct responsibilities and different stakes in using and managing natural resources in a watershed. As economic providers, caregivers, and household managers, women are responsible for ensuring that their families have basic resources for daily lives. They are often the managers of community natural resources, and have learned to protect these resources in order to preserve them for future generations (managers of sustainability). They have extensive knowledge, experience and common sense on use and management of natural sources. Women also use natural resources for economic activities, building and repair work, crops and food processing.

Highlights:

332 of women beneficiaries from the watershed area of Vadamadurai were trained in 8 number of batches for 2 days each on income generative activities.

Women/ as project officials

The Young Professional (YP), scheme was introduced in CAPART in 1988 with the main objective of inducting professionalism in the development sector. In order to encourage professionalism in the Voluntary Sectors, CAPART makes campus recruitment each year from reputed Institutions like IRMA, TISS, IIFM, DSSW etc. and deputed the recruits to work with Voluntary

Organisation(s) (VO) and CAPART's own offices.

Highlights:

On line in this aspect, 3 women CAPART Young Professionals were recruited in our organisation. The selection of the candidates was done through formal interview.

World Women's Day Celebrations

International Women's Day is an occasion marked by women's groups around the world. This date is also commemorated at the United Nations and is designated in many countries as a national holiday. When women on all continents, often divided by national boundaries and by ethnic, linguistic, cultural, economic and political differences, come together to celebrate their Day, they can look back to a tradition that represents at least nine decades of struggle for equality, justice, peace and development. In India, it is an important day, when contributions from women are highlighted and celebrated.



Highlights:

On 31st March Women's day was celebrated with the participation of 3272 women beneficiaries from 450 Self Help Group of Kadavur block of Karur district and on the same day the programme was conducted at Mondruadaippu village of Naganaeri block at Thirunelveli district with the participation of 567 women beneficiaries at the training centre.

Women Development

Mother's day celebration



Mother's Day is celebrated to honor all mothers and express gratitude for the hardships they bear in bringing up a child. Mothers Day came into being due to the efforts made by Ms Julia Ward Howe and Ms Anna Jarvis.

Highlights:

On 11 May 2008 Mothers day was celebrated with the participation of 272 women beneficiaries from 23 Self Help Group of Kadavur block of Karur district.

Short Stay Home

COODU TRUST started a short stay home for people living with HIV/AIDS (PLHA) and Drug de-addiction centre is operational in the same centre at Mylampatti, Tharagampatti (post), Karur district in the month of November 2007. The home is managed by efficient staff team includes a part time Doctor, Trained Staff Nurses, Counselor, Outreach workers, Lab Technician, Cook and a Watchman. The short stay home is equipped with 10 beds, Lab and kitchen facilities. The beneficiaries are members and known persons from the women SHG groups managed by COODU Trust. The home is having separate wards for female and Male. With the well equipped Kitchen, PLHAs are given nutrimental food with utmost care. So far we have treated 41 patients at our short stay home.



Highlights:

One hundred and twenty six PLHA were treated at this short stay home

Twenty five patients were provides comprehensive care for prevention, treatment, and rehabilitation on addiction abuses.

Fifty seven family members were given counseling on different health and family issues at this centre.

AIDS Days celebration

Theme of 2008 is "Stop AIDS. Keep the Promise - Lead - Empower - Deliver"

World AIDS Day, observed December 1st each year, is dedicated to raising awareness of the AIDS pandemic caused by the spread of HIV infection. It is common to hold memorials to honor persons who have died from HIV/AIDS on this day.



Health and Hygiene

Highlights:

At Karur district a rally cum street play was conducted and convened with the participation of 1200 persons emphasizing the theme of “Stop AIDS. Keep the Promise - Lead - Empower - Deliver” with local elected representatives along with Self Group Members and PLHA in the presence of the officials from the health departments on 1st Dec 2008.

“Samapandhi Bojana” was organized for those participants at Madha mahal at Tharampatty village of Kadarur block of Karur district on the same day.

Tamil Nadu Health Systems Project (TNHSP)

Tamil Nadu has made significant strides in improving the health status and increasing access to health care services in the last decades. The strategy envisaged focuses on improving the health status of the general population, with special emphasis on the health of low-income communities and families, over the next two decades. One among the problem is high cost mortuary van services, which is unaffordable for the rural poor to handle the dead bodies.

Highlights:

The mortuary van service of our organization is continuing its service this year also with the financial assistance of health department. Now we are charging, very low affordable cost of Rs.7/- per kilometer on kilometer basis, for one way, just to manage the system. More than 354 number of people were rendered with the service of Mortuary van at affordable cost this year. The above said service is being fully rendered and dedicated to the needy poor's. To increase the access and utilization of health services, particularly for poor, disadvantaged, and tribal groups, next year onwards we have decided to render mortuary van service at free of cost to the orphan dead bodies.



Total Sanitation Campaign (TSC)

Total Sanitation Campaign is a comprehensive programme to ensure sanitation facilities in rural areas with broader goal to eradicate the practice of open defecation. It follows a principle of “low to no subsidy” where a nominal subsidy in the form of incentive is given to rural poor households for construction of toilets. The project is being implemented in rural areas taking district as a unit of implementation.

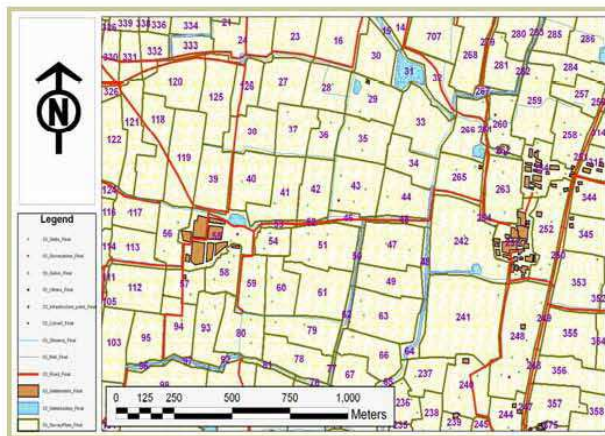
Highlights:

In order to improve the sanitation conditions of the rural poor, we have built 7522 individual household low cost latrines in 11 districts. As part of the women economic development activity we are running a rural sanitary mart at our Training center in Mylampatti is managed by trained women.

Survey and Documentation

Geographical Information Systems (GIS)

A geographic information system (GIS) integrates hardware, software, and data for capturing, managing, analyzing, and displaying all forms of geographically referenced information. A GIS is a set of information transformation tools that derive new geographic datasets from existing datasets. These geo processing functions take information



from existing datasets, apply analytic functions, and write results into new derived datasets.

Highlights:

A documentation work of digitization of village maps (421 villages) with GIS was done for Virudhunagar district with the available information from agricultural engineering department, by applying the analytical functions. By combining data and applying some analytic rules, it might help in creating a model that would answer the question posed.

Bonded labour resurvey

The Government of Tamil Nadu have ordered to undertake the resurvey of the existence of bonded labourers in all the Districts in Tamil Nadu with the financial assistance of the Government of India. A fund was sanctioned for creating awareness generation activities and evaluator studies in five districts viz. Kancheepuram, Thiruvallur, Vellore, Salem and Coimbatore.

Highlights:

The Adi Dravidar Welfare Department identified our organization in Karur district to conduct the re-survey of bonded labourers. We were given with three months period to complete the survey and was successfully completed.

Celebration of special days

National youth day

National Youth Day is celebrated in India on 12 January on the birthday of Swami Vivekananda. In 1984, the Government of India declared and decided to observe the birthday of Swami Vivekananda (12 January, according to the English calendar) as a National Youth Day every year from 1985 onwards. To quote from the Government of India's communication, 'it was felt that the philosophy of Swamiji and the ideals for which he lived and worked could be a great source of inspiration for the Indian Youth.

Highlights:

The celebration of the day was conducted in the Tharagampatti high school at Kadavur block of Karur district, with speech competition, recitation competition and competitions in essay-writing for the children, on 12 January 2009.

Children's day

In India, Children's Day is celebrated on November 14 every year. This date marks the birth anniversary of independent India's first Prime Minister, Pundit Jawaharlal Nehru. Children's day is celebrated on this day in recognition of his lifelong fondness and work for children. He always regarded all children with affection and love, and was well known for being likeable to children. Children also loved him very much and called him "Chacha Nehru" ("Chacha" meaning uncle, younger brother of father).

Highlights:

In collaboration with Nehru Yuva Kendra, children's day was conducted and prizes were distributed to the eminent and outstanding children.

World cancer day

Tackling the global burden of chronic non-communicable disease, which includes cardiovascular disease, cancers,

Special days

diabetes, and chronic respiratory disease, is one of the major challenges facing the 21st century. They cause more than 60% of all deaths globally; killing 35 million people annually. Not only are they the leading cause of death and disability worldwide, but there is an alarming increase in mortality rates in low- and middle-income countries where 80% of deaths occur. The main risk factors being: physical inactivity, obesity and tobacco use.

Highlights:

On 4th Feb 2009 World Cancer day was celebrated with a campaign at Naganaeri block at Thirunelveli district and Kadavur block of Karur district to create awareness on the hazardous affect of tobacco usage.

World TB day

World Tuberculosis Day, falling on March 24 each year, is designed to build public awareness that tuberculosis today remains an epidemic in much of the world, causing the deaths of about 1.6 million people each year. In 1996, the World Health Organization (WHO) joined with the IUATLD and a wide range of other concerned organizations to increase the impact of World TB Day.

Highlights:

On 24th March 2009 World Tuberculosis day was celebrated with a campaign at Naguneri block at Thirunelveli district and Kadavur block of Karur district to create awareness causes and affect of tuberculosis

Child labour day

FAMOUS ENGLISH poet William Wordsworth once said, "The Child is the father of the Man." With the time, the quote lost its significance and now hardly anyone cares about the saying of Wordsworth. Gruesome fact is that today the wealth of parents decide the fortune of the children whether they will enjoy the luxurious amenities or work from the childhood to earn bread. Nowadays children have been used for domestic

work, mining, agriculture and other hard works. Besides, millions of children work for long hours in factories, mostly in dangerous conditions. These children are unaware about the liberty of childhood and suffer from the cruel trend generated by civilized society.

Highlights:

For those unlucky children living in misery, the International Labour Organisation (ILO) has declared June 12 as World Day Against Child Labour, which is observed across the world. Sadly the day is not popular as Valentine Day, Friendship Day or other celebrated day, but the concerned people across the world give importance to this day and observe with great enthusiasm. We worked at our best to spread awareness among common people related to child labour on that day.

Assets and Infrastructure

Sl. No.	Place and District	Assets and Infrastructure
1	Dindigul, Tamil Nadu	2250 sq.ft Building for Office Administration
2	Karur District, Mylampatti,	3500 sq.ft Building of Training Hall with Accommodation facility & 3 Acres land
3	Karur District, Vellianai	50 Acres Agriculture Land
4	Tirunelveli, Moondradaippu	2500 sq.ft Building of Training Hall with Accommodation facility & 6 Acres Agriculture land

Advisory Board

Sl.No.	Name	Qualification	Designation
1.	Shri. C.R. Gunashekar	B.B.A, PGDM (IIPM),	Consultant, UNAIDS (Geneva), UNDP, FHI, New Delhi.
2.	Dr. S.K. Gopal	Ph.D.,	Programme Coordinator, Krishi Vigyan Kendra, Gandhigram Rural University, Gandhigram.
3.	Dr. P.J. Pandian	M.Sc., Ph.D.,	Professor, Agronomy, Tamil Nadu Agricultural University, Killikulam.
4.	Dr. Porchezian	M.VSc, Ph.D.,	Professor and Head, UVTRC, Rajapalayam.
5.	Dr. (Mrs). Girija Prabu	M.B.B.S.,	Health Consultant, Karur.
6.	Mr. C.P. Chandra ban Singh	B.Sc (Agri), M.B.A.,	Consultant, Deputy Director (Agri) (Rtrd),
7.	Dr. P.N. Ananth	M.Sc (Agri), Ph.D.,	General Manager & Senior Consultant, Ana Horna Contique Consultants, Near Imperial Hotel, Gerji, Addis Ababa, Ethiopia.
8.	Mr. P.P. Saravanan	M.Sc., (Forestry)	SMS Agro Forestry, Krishi Vigyan Kendra, Gandhigram Rural University, Gandhigram.
9.	Mr. P. Venkatesan	M.Sc., (Agri), M.B.A.	SMS Agri. Extn, Krishi Vigyan Kendra, Gandhigram Rural University, Gandhigram.
10.	Mr. Ananth	M.A., (Sociology)	Project Coordinator, MSSRF, Sempatty, Dinidgul.
11.	Mr. Rama Pandian,	B.Sc., D.Pharm, D.M.L.T	President, Tamil Nad Network of Positive People (TNP+) &, Former President, Indian Network of Positive People (INP+)
12.	Mrs. C. Thilagavathy	+2	Chairman, Serukudi Watershed Committee, Serukudi, Tiruchy Dist.
13.	Mr. T. Ramaiyah	S.S.L.C	Farmer, Mavelipatty.
14.	Mrs. Saroja	+2	Secretary, Tharagampatti SHGs Federation, Karur Dist.

Contact Details

Heads	Details
Name of the Organization	COODU Trust
Legal Status	Register No: 150 / 2000 under Indian Trust Act
Financial Approvals	8oG & 12A under Income Tax Act & FCRA
Contact Person	S. Jagadeesan
Designation	Director
Address	H - 83. R. M. Colony, Dindigul - 624 001, Tamil Nadu, India
Phone Number	+91 - 451 - 246 1362
Mobile Number	+91 - 944 306 1123, +91 - 984 212 7886
E-mail	coodustrust_1@dataone.in coodustrustindia@gmail.com
web	www.coodustrust.org